

Prahl Portfolio Work Log - July 25, 2026

Compiled summary for Saturday, July 25, 2026 - focus: continued Prahl.dev Portfolio landing-page refinement after the July 24 navigation, Articles, and Cinerific hero-tablet pass, including Full-Stack React Native / Kotlin positioning, Instagram-to-Resume CTA replacement, official LinkedIn URL and blue-color correction, social-button icon/text order changes, layered text and icon stroke treatments, responsive hero stack scaling through the one-card case-study breakpoint, proof-stat one-row behavior, Full-Stack Expertise label wrapping, local development-cache resets, public pushes, refreshed project snapshot context, review of all prior Portfolio PDF worklogs, and generation of the daily Portfolio PDF worklog.

Generated in continuity with the established Prahl Portfolio daily worklog cadence: compact opening summary, source-material section, baseline section, goal list, work-completed sections, validation section, files-touched list, follow-up context, and output-artifact close.

This artifact intentionally covers only Prahl/portfolio work performed during the July 25 local project session: the refreshed project snapshot, review of every pre-existing Portfolio worklog PDF, the landing-page/social/proof-stat work represented by commits `bbc789d`, `98ab7b5`, and `dbf93a8`, the local VS Code preview and development-cache handling, validation checks, public synchronization to origin/main, and this worklog-generation step. Alla Vostra, Cinerific, and Credit King application repositories were not changed for this record.

Source Materials Reviewed

- Ran `./read_project.sh` from `/Users/prahlin/gh/portfolio` and regenerated `portfolio_PROJECT_SNAPSHOT.txt` before writing this worklog, preserving the project convention that Codex refreshes the current source snapshot before continuing Portfolio work.
- Reviewed the refreshed `portfolio_PROJECT_SNAPSHOT.txt`, including the current source tree, app source dumps, root/tooling/deployment configuration, public image inventory, PDF inventory, git context, and the standing instruction to ask for a commit message before committing or pushing.
- Reviewed every pre-existing Portfolio root-level worklog PDF: `portfolio_worklog_july11.pdf`, `portfolio_worklog_july14.pdf`, `portfolio_worklog_july15_part1.pdf`, `portfolio_worklog_july15_part2.pdf`, `portfolio_worklog_july16.pdf`, `portfolio_worklog_july19.pdf`, `portfolio_worklog_july20.pdf`, `portfolio_worklog_july21.pdf`, `portfolio_worklog_july22.pdf`, `portfolio_worklog_july23.pdf`, and `portfolio_worklog_july24.pdf`.
- Extracted text from all eleven existing Portfolio PDFs with `pdftotext` to preserve the same title cadence, opening summary density, section order, compact bullet-heavy technical voice, validation language, files-touched list, follow-up context, and output-artifact close.
- Used `portfolio_worklog_july24.pdf` as the closest same-project reference because it documented the latest landing-page/nav/social responsive work, source-material review approach, development-cache reset language, PDF metadata expectations, and current root-level naming convention.
- Checked `portfolio_worklog_july24.pdf` metadata with `pdftinfo` and confirmed mature Portfolio artifacts use letter-size pages, Helvetica/Helvetica-Bold base fonts, six-page compact bodies, root-level filenames, and Codex standard-library PDF-generator metadata.
- Reviewed July 25 Git history through `git log`, `git show --stat`, `git diff --stat`, `git diff --name-status`, targeted source inspection, and the final HEAD/origin/main match at `dbf93a8`.
- Reviewed the committed source scopes for `bbc789d`, `98ab7b5`, and `dbf93a8`, covering landing hero text, top-nav spacing, Resume CTA conversion, social-button ordering, official LinkedIn wiring, proof-stat behavior, icon-box scaling, responsive social gaps, and public push state.
- Reviewed `app/page.tsx`, `app/globals.css`, `app/ProjectCarouselButton.tsx`, `app/ProofStats.tsx`, `package.json`, `read_project.sh`, the refreshed project snapshot, and the root-level Portfolio PDF inventory before generating this artifact.
- Checked the local development route at `http://127.0.0.1:3000/` after the July 25 work and confirmed the route returned 200 OK from the running Next.js dev server.

Baseline Status Before July 25 Work

- The July 24 Portfolio site already had the Prahlin.dev brand card, responsive two-row navigation, invisible-but-spaced Articles link, dedicated Articles route, UI/UX Philosophy card grid, long-copy collapse behavior, article scroll fixes, and Cinerific promo artwork inside the landing hero tablet.
- The landing hero still needed final positioning copy. The visible headline and surrounding role language had moved through Full Stack, RN / Kotlin, and Mobile Developer variants, but the user wanted the page to present Full-Stack React Native / Kotlin Developer as the core first-viewport signal.
- The social CTA row still carried the previous Instagram replacement work from July 24 and needed to become a Resume control with the user-requested spelling, icon, color treatment, and social-button-box parity.
- The LinkedIn social button still needed the final public destination URL at <https://linkedin.com/in/mprahl> and needed its fill color verified against official LinkedIn blue rather than a nearby custom shade.
- The Resume, LinkedIn, and GitHub buttons had similar layout roles but different visual weights. Their icon boxes, label fills, strokes, gaps, and color contrast needed repeated user-directed tuning so they looked intentionally related rather than separately styled.
- The hero action/text/asset stack stopped growing too early during window widening. The user screenshot showed featured case studies still at one card per row while the hero button/text/assets had already stopped stretching or scaling.
- The proof-stat card already contained 3yrs, 1.0k+, 0.1k+, and 8, but the first label and narrow-window line behavior needed additional control so all four columns retained equal row quantity.
- The local development workflow still required occasional cache clearing because browser and VS Code preview surfaces could show stale Next.js output after rapid CSS and JSX iteration.

Goals for July 25

- Reposition the first viewport around Full-Stack React Native / Kotlin Developer while preserving the existing green/black hero visual system, role lede, CTA stack, chips, proof panel, and device artwork.
- Reduce the top navigation vertical spacing by the requested 25 percent without disturbing the two-row responsive nav behavior accepted on July 24.
- Replace the Instagram social CTA with a Resume button using a download icon, matched outer button box proportions, and final user-approved spelling without an accent mark.
- Point the LinkedIn button to <https://linkedin.com/in/mprahl> and change its blue to the official LinkedIn company/web color requested by the user.
- Swap the internal social-button asset order so each social button uses icon-left/text-right placement, while preserving the alignment relationship between the green project CTA and the hero Check Out Projects label.
- Bring the three social icon boxes into visual parity by matching icon-box dimensions, then nudging GitHub upward where its black border visually blended into the black button fill.
- Tune the social-button label colors and stroke layers so GitHub, LinkedIn, and Resume each read clearly against their fills, with button-specific middle colors and black outer separation where requested.
- Extend hero stack scaling through the same one-card case-study responsive window range and stop that growth only once featured case-study cards transition from one card per row to multiple cards per row.
- Force the four proof stats to remain in a single row and make Full-Stack Expertise wrap as Full-, Stack, Expertise when the narrow-window label line count needs to match the other columns.
- Keep changes local until the user asked to push, then commit and push the approved source changes to the public main branch.

Work Completed - Hero Positioning, Nav, and Preview Workflow

- Ran the project read script and reviewed project snapshots and worklogs at the start of the working sequence so subsequent changes stayed grounded in the Portfolio repo conventions.
- Updated the hero headline through the requested copy sequence and landed the final two-line treatment as Full-Stack followed by React Native / Kotlin Developer.
- Changed the visible Full Stack wording to the hyphenated Full-Stack form where requested,

including the hero headline and proof-stat label path.

- Preserved the existing hero eyebrow, HeroLede component, green project CTA, stack-chip row, proof panel, and device-stage artwork while altering only the requested role and CTA areas.
- Reduced top-navigation vertical spacing in app/globals.css by tightening the responsive nav row/gap relationship from the prior July 24 state, keeping the established brand-card and two-row structure intact.
- Opened <http://127.0.0.1:3000/> through the VS Code editor-preview flow for the user and clarified that the editor view uses VS Code built-in webview/browser behavior rather than the normal external Chrome window.
- Handled the blank editor-view moment by continuing with the local dev server and editor/browser preview setup until the user confirmed they had the preview open.
- Cleared the local Next.js development cache on request by moving the stale .next/dev directory aside and restarting the local dev server, keeping those cache resets local-only when requested.
- Repeated cache-clearing passes after rapid social-button and stroke-style updates so the visible page could catch up to the current source during the design iteration.

Work Completed - Resume, LinkedIn, and GitHub Social Buttons

- Converted the previous Instagram social CTA into a Resume CTA and replaced the Instagram-style visual with a custom boxed download icon.
- Iterated the Resume spelling from the accented Resumé treatment to the final Resume label after the user clarified that no accent mark should remain on the first or final e.
- Matched the Resume button outer box to the other social buttons instead of leaving it as a visually unrelated CTA, then adjusted its fill through several user-reviewed color options.
- Tested and discussed multiple Resume fill directions, including yellow/orange families, mint #A7F3D0, green options such as #15803D, neutral #CBD5E1, and the final white button fill with green icon-box treatment.
- Changed the Resume icon arrow/tray fill and stroke behavior repeatedly until the final treatment used a green icon box, white arrow/tray fill, and black icon strokes inside the white Resume button.
- Set the Resume label to white with a layered stroke stack, then moved the visible middle stroke to green so the word visually connects to the green download icon box.
- Adjusted the Resume text stroke stack through the requested values and balance passes, including inner black stroke behavior, green middle stroke visibility, and black outer hairline visibility.
- Copied the same multi-layer label-stroke model to LinkedIn and GitHub with button-specific middle colors: LinkedIn uses its blue middle layer, GitHub uses a charcoal/gray middle layer, and Resume uses green.
- Changed LinkedIn to the official requested blue #2867B2 and updated its href to <https://linkedin.com/in/mprahl>.
- Preserved the accepted LinkedIn icon-box artwork after later changes, including the white boxed in mark, black outline, and blue letter/shape fills.
- Inverted the GitHub button color system so the button fill became black and the GitHub label/icon fill shifted light, without touching LinkedIn or Resume assets during the GitHub-only instruction.
- Inverted the GitHub icon-box colors separately from the label so the brace mark remained legible inside the black social button.
- Scaled the Resume icon box up in two 10 percent passes, then matched the GitHub and LinkedIn icon boxes to the Resume icon-box dimensions.
- Nudged the GitHub icon box slightly larger than strict border measurement parity because its black border visually blended into the black button fill and made the filled icon box read smaller.
- Swapped the horizontal placement of text/icons inside each social button so all three buttons now use icon-left/text-right ordering.
- Restored the social-button horizontal gap to match across buttons after a wider Resume gap was rejected, then added 1px to the narrowest gap while allowing the gap to keep growing responsively as the window widens.
- Doubled the maximum responsive gap range during very wide hero stretching so icon and label assets do not remain cramped after the button stack scales up.

Work Completed - Responsive Hero Stack and Proof Stats

- Extended hero stack scaling in the max-width: 980px responsive range by tying --hero-proof-stack-width, --hero-action-stack-width, and --hero-text-stack-width to min(606px, 100%).
- Aligned that 606px growth stop with the one-card featured-case-study breakpoint near 630px, so the hero action/text/assets continue widening while case studies are still one card per row.
- Responded to the user screenshot showing one case-study card per row and unchanged hero scaling by increasing the responsive hero stack target from the earlier value to the current 606px value.
- Kept the green project CTA and Check Out Projects label order unchanged after discussing that text-left/device-assets-right within the green CTA was not itself a usability problem when the button still read clearly.
- Updated ProjectCarouselButton measurement logic so the Check Out Projects label aligns to the full GitHub icon/text cluster regardless of whether the social button uses text-first or icon-first internal ordering.
- Changed the social-button scaling logic so social label font size, icon size, internal padding, project CTA font sizes, arrow size, and view-label size are derived from the measured social-button height.
- Kept all three social buttons locked to the same 4.5 / 2 aspect ratio and shared hero-action grid so button stretching remains synchronized with the carousel CTA.
- Forced the proof-stat card to render all four items in one row instead of returning to a two-by-two arrangement during compressed hero widths.
- Renamed the first proof stat from Full Stack Expertise to Full-Stack Expertise and then restored the full phrase after an intermediate shortened Full-Stack request.
- Updated ProofStats.tsx so Full-Stack Expertise is treated as Full-, Stack, Expertise in the tightest label mode, allowing Stack to count as its own visual word and keeping row quantity equal across all four proof-stat columns.
- Preserved the other proof stat labels as Quality GitHub Commits, Real-Time Project Worklogs, and Shipped Mob/Web Products while letting the shared measurement controller pick one-line, two-line, or three-line modes.

Work Completed - Public Synchronization and Commit Handling

- Recommended commit messages in the user-requested styles during the July 25 sequence, including one-header plus three-to-five hyphen bullets and later one-line past-tense summaries when requested.
- Committed and pushed the first July 25 source pass as bbc789d, Refined landing hero, nav, and resume CTA, after the Resume conversion, LinkedIn URL update, top-nav spacing reduction, and hero scaling changes.
- Committed and pushed the second July 25 source pass as 98ab7b5, Refined hero social buttons and proof stats, after the social stroke layers, official LinkedIn blue, icon-first ordering, proof-stat one-row behavior, and Full-Stack wrapping changes.
- Committed and pushed the third July 25 source pass as dbf93a8, Refined hero social button spacing, labels, and icon scaling to compensate for any potential optical illusions inferred by the user due to color contrast between text fonts & icon box fillings/borders.
- Confirmed the final source branch state had HEAD and origin/main both at dbf93a85c80f54092e238381d056097e19fc1b37 before this PDF was generated.
- Kept the documentation artifact changes local during this worklog pass because the user requested a PDF worklog, not an additional commit or public push for the refreshed snapshot and new PDF.

Validation and Checks Performed

- Ran npm run check after the current July 25 source state and confirmed TypeScript validation passed with tsc --noEmit.
- Confirmed http://127.0.0.1:3000/ returned 200 OK from the local Next.js development server after the source work and cache-clearing sequence.
- Verified git rev-parse HEAD and git rev-parse origin/main both returned dbf93a85c80f54092e238381d056097e19fc1b37 before generating this worklog.
- Confirmed git status showed main tracking origin/main with only the refreshed

portfolio_PROJECT_SNAPSHOT.txt modified before this PDF was created.

- Reviewed git diff --stat from the July 24 worklog commit through current HEAD and confirmed the July 25 source scope was app/page.tsx, app/globals.css, app/ProjectCarouselButton.tsx, app/ProofStats.tsx, and the regenerated snapshot context.
- Reviewed git show --stat for bbc789d, confirming the first pass touched app/globals.css, app/page.tsx, and portfolio_PROJECT_SNAPSHOT.txt for the hero/nav/Resume CTA changes.
- Reviewed git show --stat for 98ab7b5, confirming the second pass touched app/ProjectCarouselButton.tsx, app/ProofStats.tsx, app/globals.css, and app/page.tsx for social-button/proof-stat work.
- Reviewed git show --stat for dbf93a8, confirming the final source pass touched app/ProjectCarouselButton.tsx, app/globals.css, and app/page.tsx for social spacing, label, and icon-box refinements.
- Regenerated portfolio_PROJECT_SNAPSHOT.txt before this PDF so the current source tree, recent commits, image inventory, PDF inventory, and public sync context were represented locally.
- Generated this PDF with the same standard-library PDF writer style used by the mature Portfolio worklogs and checked metadata/text extraction after writing.

Files Touched During July 25 Portfolio Work

- app/page.tsx - updated hero headline copy, proof-stat label data, Resume/LinkedIn/GitHub social button markup, Resume download mark, LinkedIn destination URL, official LinkedIn blue constant, GitHub and Resume icon-box treatments, social label data-text attributes, and final social-button asset order.
- app/globals.css - tuned top-nav spacing, hero stack responsive widths, social-button aspect ratio, social font/icon/gap variables, GitHub/LinkedIn/Resume fills, label stroke layers, icon sizing, proof-stat one-row behavior, and narrow/wide responsive social spacing.
- app/ProjectCarouselButton.tsx - updated hero action geometry measurement so social-button height drives related font/icon variables and the Check Out Projects label aligns to the measured GitHub icon/text cluster after icon-first ordering.
- app/ProofStats.tsx - added the special Full-Stack Expertise line-splitting behavior that treats Full-, Stack, and Expertise as separate tight-mode lines while preserving shared label-mode measurement for all four stats.
- portfolio_PROJECT_SNAPSHOT.txt - regenerated by ./read_project.sh for this worklog pass and left modified locally as a project-context artifact.
- portfolio_worklog_july25.pdf - generated as this daily Portfolio worklog artifact in the root-level Portfolio worklog convention.

Follow-Up Context

- The public website source is already represented by origin/main at dbf93a8, and the July 25 source commits have been pushed to the main branch.
- The refreshed portfolio_PROJECT_SNAPSHOT.txt and this July 25 PDF remain local until the user provides or approves a commit message for documentation artifact changes.
- Because this PDF increases the Portfolio worklog count from 11 to 12, visible public copy can be updated later only if the user wants the portfolio surface to reflect exact artifact count rather than the current rounded 0.1k+ proof stat.
- The Resume button is visually converted to Resume with a download icon, but the current href still preserves the previous external placeholder destination. A real resume PDF/link should replace that URL when the resume asset or final destination is supplied.
- The LinkedIn button now points to <https://linkedin.com/in/mprahl> and uses #2867B2, so future LinkedIn styling should preserve that user-approved destination/color unless intentionally revised.
- The social label stroke stack currently depends on layered text and pseudo-elements. Future edits should test GitHub, LinkedIn, and Resume together because changing one layer width can make middle colors disappear or dominate.
- The GitHub icon box was intentionally nudged by optical fill size rather than border-box size because black border-on-black-button contrast made strict dimensions appear smaller.
- The hero stack growth is intentionally tied to the one-card case-study responsive window. Future breakpoint changes to .case-grid should be checked against --hero-proof-stack-width and the 606px hero stack target.

- The proof-stat one-row behavior and Full-/Stack/Expertise split are deliberate. Later label edits should verify that all four proof columns still use the same visible line count in narrow windows.
- Continue treating all future Portfolio work as local-only unless the user explicitly asks to commit, push, deploy, publish, or update the public website.

Output Artifact

- Generated file: portfolio_worklog_july25.pdf.
- Location: /Users/prahlin/gh/portfolio/portfolio_worklog_july25.pdf.
- Naming follows the existing root-level Portfolio convention: portfolio_worklog_july25.pdf. No part suffix was used because this is the first July 25 Portfolio worklog artifact.
- Uses the same daily worklog structure and compact technical voice established by portfolio_worklog_july11.pdf through portfolio_worklog_july24.pdf.
- Generated with a small standard-library PDF writer; no external PDF dependency was installed for this artifact.
- The local project date used for this filename and title is Saturday, July 25, 2026 EDT, matching the machine and repository work session clock.